

Turkic Languages

Edited by
Lars Johanson

in cooperation with
Hendrik Boeschoten, Bernt Brendemoen,
Éva Á. Csató, Peter B. Golden, Tooru Hayasi, Birsal Karakoç,
Astrid Menz, Irina Nevskaya, Sumru A. Özsoy, Elisabetta Ragagnin,
Saule Tazhibayeva and Abdurishid Yakup

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Manuscripts for publication, books for review, and all correspondence concerning editorial matters should be sent to Prof. Dr. Dr. h.c. Lars Johanson, Turkic Languages, Department of Slavistics, Turcology and Circum-Baltic Studies, University of Mainz, 55099 Mainz, Germany. The email address johanson@uni-mainz.de may also be used for communication.

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Editorial Note

Turkic Languages, Volume 24, 2020, Number 2

The present issue of *TURKIC LANGUAGES* contains articles that are of a more general scope, as well as more specialized contributions.

Alina Dochu deals with the Turkic origin of some East Slavic ornithonyms, which can be of interest because of the direct language contacts between Turks and the East Slavs. Turkic influence on the East Slavic languages has not yet been thoroughly studied. The names of birds pertain to an ancient language layer which shows a certain resistance to foreign language contacts. It will thus be of great concern to know the intensity of Turkic influence on the East Slavic ornithonymic layer. The article describes literary names of birds and also different folk names that do not change with the passage of time. Words of Turkic origin which have received a secondary ornithonymic meanings are also mentioned. Crimean Tatar is mostly influenced by Ukrainian and Belarusian, while Russian has mainly been influenced by Tatar.

Hendrik Boeschoten presents the second part of his contribution to the lexicography of early Middle Turkic. More lexical material is listed and the influence of combinational copying from Arabic and Persian is discussed. The author has analyzed a number of cases cropping up in a database that covers works mainly from the 14th century, but also from the 13th and 15th centuries. He discusses some mistakes made by the editors of the works included. It makes sense to approach the lexicography of pre-modern Turkic languages with a history of written varieties in slices of time, rather than on the basis of alphabets used, geographical locations or tribal background. The linguistic analysis of the materials is often scarce, and the transcription of many items is insecure. Systematic lexicographical comparison of certain types of works is needed. An investigation into the kinds of copying from Arabic and Persian is essential for a full understanding of the lexical inventory of written Turkic of the period. The author hopes that others might be inspired to do some work in the field. The literature cited can be found in the first part of the article, while a few additional items are added at the end.

Aminem Memtimin describes the Äynu variety spoken in the south of the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region in China. The article is mainly based on her own field work in the village of Šäyγil in Kashgar prefecture and in the villages Tameyil and Givov in Khotan prefecture. Although the Äynus are gradually abandoning their traditional lifestyle, their language still shows vitality. Some lexical and grammatical differences exhibit dialectal features. The author also visited women, which is important since women are known to be better repositories than men of original culture and language. Women are normally in less contact with outsiders and are more competent to transmit the culture to their offspring.

İbrahim Ahmet Aydemir deals with grammaticalized expressions of modality in Altay Tuvan, a dialect spoken by the Tsengel Tuvans in the western part of Mongolia. Various synthetic and analytic devices express voluntative, optative, hypothetical, necessitative, potential, confirmative, presumptive, and prospective modalities. These devices are compared to other varieties of Tuvan. The author presents data collected during his own field work.

Florian Siegl reports on the central negation strategies in Taimyr Dolgan, a Turkic minority language of Central Northern Siberia. Although the morphological basics of negation have been covered in two major grammars, a comprehensive survey of negation covering morphology, syntax and semantics has not been compiled until now. This study approaches Dolgan from a functional-typological perspective that does not use Yakut for comparison.

A report describes the work of a team collecting data on Turkic languages for an atlas of the languages of Iran.

After the early death of Dmitrij Mixajlovič Nasilov, a faithful and beloved member of our editorial collegium, we now publish a short obituary of his life and astonishing capacities.

Today we have the sad duty to announce the recent passing of Barbara Flemming (28.6.1930–22.3.2020), an Ottoman scholar who spent most of her career in Leiden. We will return to her and her achievements at a later date.

The famous German scholar Erika Taube, a specialist in the study of the Tuvan language and folklore, has passed away (22.11.1933–3.7.2020). She had made important contributions to this journal and the series *Turcologica*.

Lars Johanson

Report

Turkic languages in the *Atlas of the Languages of Iran* (ALI)

Erik Anonby & Mortaza Taheri-Ardali & Laurentia Schreiber & Christiane Bulut & Geoffrey Haig & Peiman Pishyar Dehkordi & Mahnaz Talebi-Dastenaiei & Fatemeh Shahverdi & Hossein Hashemi Zarajabad & Masoud Mohammadirad & Faranak Jamaledin & Zohreh Rahnema & Mohammad Mohammadi & Elham Izady & Mehrdad Meshkinfam & Ergin Öpengin & Fatemeh Nemati

Anonby, Erik & Taheri-Ardali, Mortaza & Schreiber, Laurentia & Bulut, Christiane & Haig, Geoffrey & Pishyar Dehkordi, Peiman & Talebi-Dastenaiei, Mahnaz & Shahverdi, Fatemeh & Hashemi Zarajabad, Hossein & Mohammadirad, Masoud & Jamaledin, Faranak & Rahnema, Zohreh & Mohammadi, Mohammad & Izady, Elham & Meshkinfam, Mehrdad & Öpengin, Ergin & Nemati, Fatemeh 2020. Turkic languages in the *Atlas of the Languages of Iran* (ALI). *Turkic Languages* 24, 290–308.

The *Atlas of the Languages of Iran* (ALI), initiated in 2014, is a long-term research programme that aims to develop a comprehensive overview of the language situation in Iran, with attention to the distribution of language varieties, their structural characteristics, and relationships among the varieties. The Atlas deals with all languages of Iran, and since Turkic-speaking communities are found in most provinces, the Turkic language family features prominently. In this article, we look at three important issues relating to Turkic in the Atlas, in the order that they have been initiated in the research process. First, we present the ongoing classification of Turkic languages in Iran as a scientific frame, serving as both foundation and key goal of the research. Second, we describe our initial approach to Turkic language communities through a systematic inquiry into language distribution and the collection of local place names. Third, we provide an inventory of Turkic linguistic questionnaire data collected and analyzed up to now, along with an overview of results. The paper concludes with reflections on progress, challenges, and future directions in the documentation of Iran's Turkic languages in the context of the ALI programme.

Keywords: Iran, Turkic languages, language documentation, language mapping, language classification

Atlas of the Languages of Iran (ALI), School of Linguistics and Language Studies (SLaLS), Carleton University, 1125 Colonel By Drive, Ottawa, Ontario K1S 5B6, Canada. Email: erik.anonby@carleton.ca, taheri@sku.ac.ir.

Introduction

Turkic languages are spoken in a wide, uneven band from north-eastern Asia across to south-eastern Europe.¹ They are best known from Turkey, where Standard Turkish is the national language, and from Azerbaijan and central Asian republics where Turkic languages are likewise official.

In Iran, Turkic languages do not have official status, but are estimated to be spoken as a mother tongue by 15 to 20 million people (Johanson 1998a: 326, Eberhard et al. 2019). Despite their important contribution to the linguistic landscape in Iran, these languages have not been systematically documented. The best-known Turkic varieties there are South (or Iranian) Azerbaijani and Qashqai, but even for these, precise geographic extent and internal classification are not yet established.

Doerfer (1998, 2006) and Bulut (2014, 2018) provide the most complete overviews of Turkic languages in Iran, with attention to history, classification, and linguistic typology. There are several studies of Turkic-Persian language contact for the country as a whole (e.g., Johanson 1998a, 2002, Bulut 2005, 2006). Work on South Azerbaijani (SA) includes grammatical descriptions and topics (Deghani 2000, Lee 2008, Hashemi Zarajabad 2008), as well as SA-specific language contact studies (Johanson 1988, Kırıl 2001, Erfani 2012, Ganji 2014, Hashemi Zarajabad 2015a). Asadpour (2012) and Rezāqolifāmian (2013) have worked on linguistic mapping for areas where South Azerbaijani is spoken. Dolatkah (2016, 2019) has written a grammar of Qashqai (Qashqāi), and Bulut (2016), Csátó (2005) and Soper (1996) have published individual studies focusing on contact of Qashqai with Persian. Doerfer (1971, 1988) described historical phonology and grammar of the distinctive Turkic language Khalaj (see also Kırıl 2000a, 2000b for individual studies on two morphosyntactic aspects of Khalaj), and for this language prepared an atlas of linguistic structures (Doerfer 1987)—the most complete atlas for any single language of Iran. Ragagnin's (2020) article gives further insight into selected grammatical structures in Khalaj from a contact linguistics perspective. Other Turkic varieties of Iran that have been investigated are Khorasan Turkic (Doerfer 1977, Fázsy 1977, Tulu 1989), Turkmen (Azmun 1978) and, also in reference to contact with Iranian, Turkic of Sonqor in Kermanshah Province (Bulut 2005) and Galugāh in Mazandaran (Hashemi Zarajabad 2015b). Alongside these key works, there are many further individual studies; see Bulut (2014, 2018) and Ragagnin (2020) for additional references.

Given both the extent and diversity of Turkic varieties in Iran, scholarly understanding of their geographic distribution and structural diversity is far from complete. There is no satisfactory map of Turkic languages in Iran, the most detailed

1 We wish to thank the Turkic-speaking consultants who generously shared knowledge about their languages with researchers working in the ALI programme. This paper is the result of collaborative work by many team members; a full list of team members is available at: <http://iranatlas.net/module/atlasteam>. Individual contributions of colleagues to work on Turkic in the Atlas are detailed throughout the paper.

being that of Izady (2006–2019), where Turkic-speaking areas are shown as part of the general picture of language distribution. Typological classification of varieties is complicated by intricate histories of migration, language contact, and varied registers—from koinés used by ethnopolitical confederacies (Bulut 2016: 243–246) to language use which is restricted to the home. Throughout the country, Iranic superstrates—and often substrates as well—exert a defining influence on the structure of Turkic (Stilo 2004).

In this article, we provide an overview of initial research and findings on Turkic languages that are coming out of the *Atlas of the Languages of Iran* (ALI). This research programme, initiated in 2014, exists to enable work toward a systematic understanding of the language situation in Iran (Anonby, Taheri-Ardali & Hayes 2019). With an online Atlas at its core (<http://iranatlas.net>), this initiative is guided by a set of interrelated themes and questions:

- Linguistic and areal typology: What are important linguistic features of Iran’s languages and dialects, and how are they distributed geographically?
- Language distribution: Where are these language varieties spoken, and how does this compare to the distribution of linguistic features?
- Language classification: How do scholars and speakers classify these language varieties, and how can scholarly classifications be improved?
- Language documentation: A record of the linguistic situation in Iran and a repository of linguistic data in the face of declining linguistic diversity with the extension of Tehran-influenced standard Persian as a mother tongue across the country.

Here, we focus on our work in Turkic languages, considering three important issues relating to Turkic in the Atlas, in the order that they have been addressed in the research process. We first present the ongoing classification of Turkic languages in Iran as a scientific frame, since it serves both as a basis for the research and one of its key goals (Section 2). We then describe our initial approach to Turkic language communities through a systematic inquiry into language distribution, and collection of local place names (Section 3). This is followed by an account of linguistic data collection through the implementation of a linguistic data questionnaire in selected locations (Section 4). The paper concludes with reflections on progress, challenges, and future directions in the documentation of Iran’s Turkic languages in the context of the ALI programme (Section 5).

Classification of Turkic languages in Iran

Language classification acts as a scientific frame for the Atlas research programme: existing work on classification serves as a foundation for the research, and the refinement of this classification is a key goal. For the research process itself, it is also important for the consistent labelling of language varieties, selection of sites for in-

depth language data collection, organization of language data, and decisions in the construction and presentation of maps (Anonby 2017; Anonby & Hayes & Oikle 2020).

In order to assemble a comprehensive classification of Turkic languages and dialects in Iran, Erik Anonby consulted the literature, with a careful review of Johanson (1998b), Doerfer (2006), Bulut (2014) and *Ethnologue* (Eberhard et al. 2019); Johanson's (in press) classification of Turkic has now also been considered. Anonby also took note of the Turkic varieties listed in the map of Iran's languages produced by Izady (2006–2019). On the one side, in these papers Johanson, Doerfer, and Bulut limit themselves to general themes and questions for classification of Turkic in Iran, and while touching on important historical, areal and typological tendencies, they do not attempt to provide a complete and detailed classification. *Ethnologue* and Izady, in contrast, propose a fuller list of Turkic language varieties and list several branches of the family but (in keeping with the general nature of their contributions) do not provide commentary to support their selection of language varieties or their assessment of relationships among them. In short, no detailed or comprehensive classification of Turkic in Iran has been proposed.

Based on a summary of the literature, Anonby submitted a draft classification of Turkic in Iran to several experts in the field, and received detailed feedback from Christiane Bulut (pers. comm. 2015) in particular. Along with careful review of this draft classification, Bulut emphasized that classification of Turkic in Iran is problematic because of the history of settlement of Turkic-speaking communities in the country (Bulut 2014, 2018). To summarize, there have been longstanding movements of Turkic-speaking communities in various directions around the region, and these have continued into recent history. Most classifications of Turkic in Iran use either geographic (e.g., Fars Province, Zanjan Province) or ethnopolitical labels (Qashqai, Inanlu, Shāhsavan, etc.) as linguistic labels, but many of these groupings are in fact linguistically heterogeneous, reflecting the diverse origins of their constitution. For example, as Bulut (2016) points out, Qashqai is not a single language variety, but a diverse cluster of Oghuz varieties. Being in the same geographic area, they are subject to equivalent effects of structural influence from Iranic contact varieties (Bulut 2016: 246; Anonby & Taheri-Ardali & Schreiber 2020) and converge with one another as a simple effect of their proximity and self-identification as part of a single tribal confederacy (Bulut 2016: 244–245). Some of the members of the confederacy still speak other languages (e.g., Balochi; see Nourzaei et al. 2018) as a mother tongue, and others have done so in the past (Oberling 2003, Bulut 2016: 245).

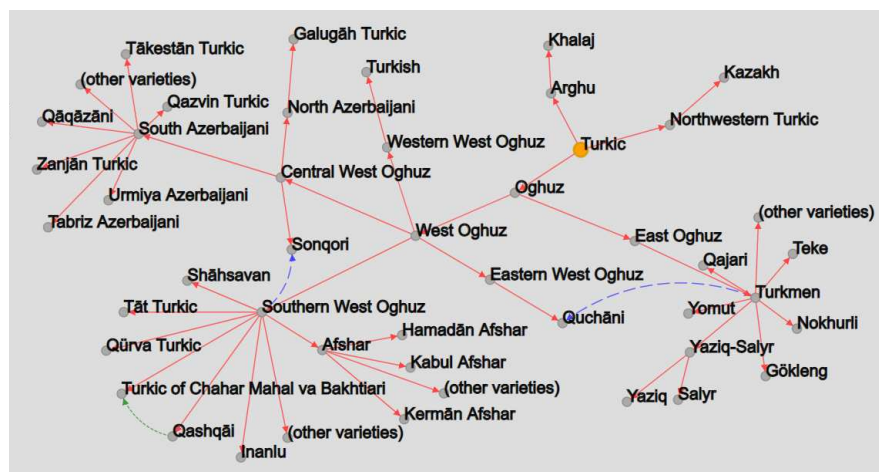
Results from our current research on classification of Iran's languages, which is a work in progress, are expressed in two formats. First, we provide a traditional two-dimensional tree representation (Anonby in Anonby & Taheri-Ardali et al. 2015–2020)

Figure 1: Working classification of Turkic in Iran, traditional tree structure (from <http://iranatlas.net/module/classification>). Sources and justifications for individual classification sections are found at this page.

- Arghu
 - Khalaj
- Oghuz (Southwestern)
 - West Oghuz (Saljuq Oghuz)
 - Western West Oghuz
 - Turkish (Turkish of Turkey; Istanbul Turkish)
 - Central West Oghuz (Azerbaijani; Āzarbaijāni; Azeri; Āzari)
 - North Azerbaijani (Azerbaijani of Azerbaijan)
 - Galugāh Turkic
 - South Azerbaijani (Azerbaijani of Iran)
 - Urmiya Azerbaijani
 - Tabriz Azerbaijani
 - Zanjān Turkic
 - Qazvin Turkic
 - Tākestān Turkic
 - Qāqāzāni
 - [other varieties]
 - Sonqori (Sonqor Turkic)
 - Southern West Oghuz
 - Afshar (Afsar)
 - Hamadān Afshar
 - Kermān Afshar
 - Kabul Afshar (Qabol Afshar)
 - [other varieties]
 - Shāhsavan
 - Tāt Turkic
 - Qūrva Turkic
 - Turkic of Chahār Mahāl va Bakhtiāri
 - Qashqāi (Qashqā'i; Kashkai; Kashkay)
 - Inanlu (Inallu; Inanil; Aynallu)
 - [other varieties]
 - Eastern West Oghuz
 - Quchāni (Khorāsāni Turkic)
- East Oghuz (Non-Saljuq Oghuz)
 - Turkmen
 - Yomut
 - Gökleng
 - Teke
 - Nokhurli
 - Yaziq-Salyr (Yaziq-Salur)
 - Yaziq
 - Salyr (Salur)
 - Qajari
 - [other varieties]
- Northwestern (Kipchak, Qipchaq)
 - Kazakh

The same content can be expressed through a language relation web, using the multi-dimensional classification model that we have developed for the Atlas. In addition to enabling a clear representation of complex genealogical (linguistic genetic) parentage, this model can distinguish structural effects of contact, and the role of ethnicity, in the defining and classifying of language varieties. (For further description of the model, and the procedure used to build these webs, see Anonby 2017; Anonby & Hayes & Oikle 2020) The result for Turkic languages of Iran—still a working classification—is as follows (Figure 2):

Figure 2: Working classification of Turkic in Iran, multi-dimensional language relation web (from: <http://iranatlas.net/module/taxonomy.selectMap>). Solid red lines represent genealogical relation. Dashed blue lines represent contact influence, as exemplified by Quchāni (Khorāsāni Turkic), an Eastern West Oghuz variety which has undergone sustained influence from the East Oghuz variety Turkmen. Dotted green lines represent ethnic self-identification: this is shown in the diagram for Turkic of Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari, where based on ethnicity some people consider their variety as Qashqai, even though structurally it appears to be quite different from Qashqai varieties documented elsewhere



While both of these models are working classifications, and open to additions and improvements, we believe that they are the first classifications to bring together the literature on Turkic in Iran and make explicit relationships among all major Turkic varieties of the country as well as many of the sub-varieties.

This classificatory work for Turkic languages in Iran is an iterative, ongoing activity in the Atlas programme. It guides the selection of sites for language data collection, prepares field researchers for encounters with particular varieties, and highlights unresolved questions to address in the course of fieldwork (Anonby, Taheri-Ardali & Hayes 2019). In this way, field research can lead, and is already leading, to refinements in the classification of Turkic languages in Iran.

Language distribution

Research into language distribution is the major first step in the Atlas fieldwork process for each province. As described in related papers (Anonby & Taheri-Ardali & Hayes 2019; Anonby & Mohammadirad & Sheyholislami 2019), this stage of the research involves the collection of language distribution information for each settlement in all districts of a province. For each city, town, and village, we inventory the names of the languages and dialects that are spoken there and estimate the proportion of people that speak each of the varieties as a mother tongue. Because of the complexities involved in assessing degrees of multilingualism, our province-wide surveys of language distribution are limited to localization of the mother tongue (which we also refer to here as first language, or L1).

As part of our initial approach to language communities, who are one of several key audiences for the Atlas, we also collect and transcribe local pronunciation of place names; these are often different from their official names.

We have completed this systematic overview of language distribution in five provinces so far, in the following chronological order: Hormozgan, Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari, Kordestan, Bushehr and Ilam. This has enabled us to complete the first detailed language distribution maps for each of the provinces, all available at <http://iranatlas.net> (Anonby & Taheri-Ardali et al. 2015–2020).

Although none of these provinces has a Turkic-speaking majority, there are significant minorities in several of them. A summary of our findings is as follows:

Hormozgan. In our initial language distribution research on Hormozgan Province (Mohebbi Bahmani & Rashidi et al. 2015), colleagues working in the western part of the province reported that Qashqai was spoken by some of the people in the village of Kondorān, near the city of Bandar Lengeh. Taheri-Ardali carried out linguistic data questionnaires in this region in 2017, and made plans to study the Qashqai variety spoken there. Arriving in Kondorān, he found that a majority of the village's population is Arab, and speaks Arabic as a mother tongue. There are still some ethnic Qashqai people living in this village, but they have shifted to a Buchiri-type dialect of Larestāni, which is spoken in some of the nearby villages (Mortaza Taheri-Ardali, field notes 2017). We are not aware of any other Turkic communities in Hormozgan Province.

Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari. While still in its early stages, our study of Turkic is most advanced here. Initial language distribution research showed that Turkic varieties are spoken in 60 communities in the north-east corner of Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari (C&B) Province. In most of these communities, including 6 cities with populations of over 10,000 (Ben, Sāmān, Kiān, Juneqān, Boldāji and Farādonbeh), Turkic is the primary mother tongue. In the provincial capital of Shahr-e Kord, about 15% of the city's population of 190,000 (=28,600) is Turkic-speaking, making this the largest Turkic-language community in the province. Based on a village-by-village count, we estimate the total proportion of L1 Turkic speakers in the province at 17%. Applied to the 2016 census information for C&B as a whole (pop. 950,000),

the total number of L1 Turkic speakers in the province is about 160,000 (Taheri-Ardali et al. 2015, ISC 2016). In addition, there is a small number of L2 Turkic speakers in Turkic-dominated multilingual towns such as Juneqan (Anonby, Schreiber & Taheri-Ardali forthcoming). Figure 3 shows communities where Turkic is spoken as a mother tongue in C&B.

Figure 3: Turkic-speaking communities of Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari Province (from: http://iranatlas.net/module/language-distribution.single_language).

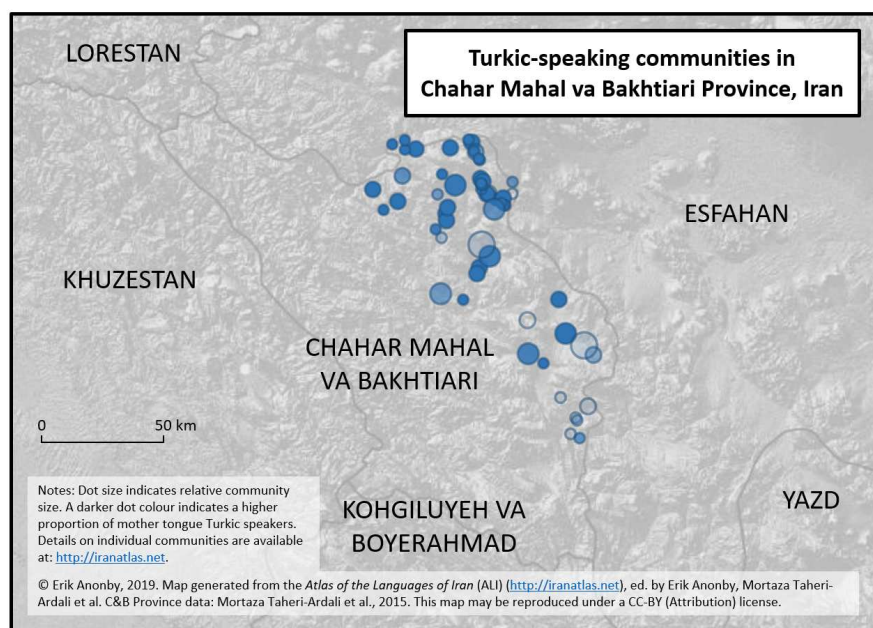


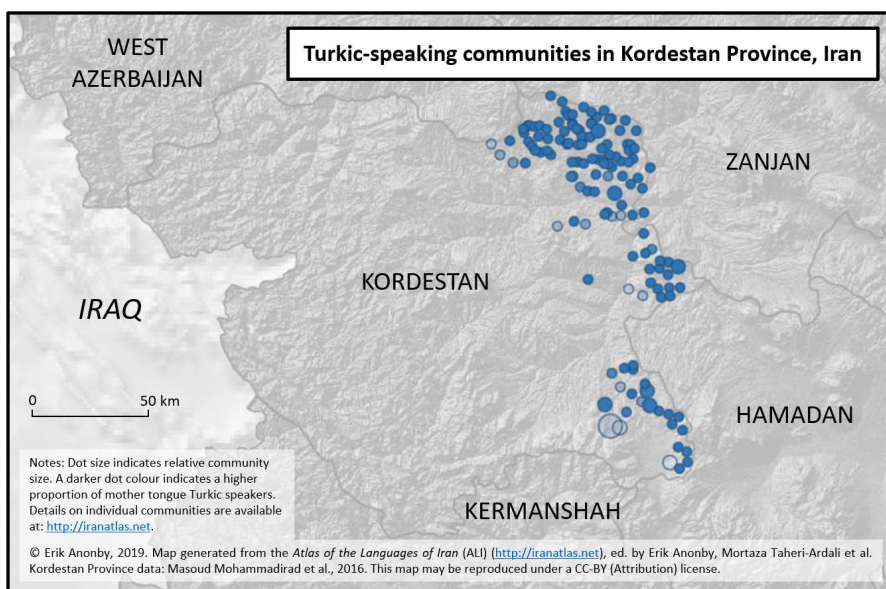
Figure 3 shows only L1 Turkic-speaking communities, but these towns are interspersed with a similar concentration of Charmahali-speaking communities in the north-east, and Bakhtiari-speaking communities in the centre and the east. (For wider context see the multilingual province map, which shows the main language spoken in each settlement in the province, at: http://iranatlas.net/module/language-distribution.chahar_mahal_va_bakhtiari.) Almost all of the cities where Turkic is spoken, and some villages, are shared with speakers of Charmahali and Bakhtiari. In these settlements, individual multilingualism is the norm (for an illustration of this, see Anonby, Schreiber & Taheri-Ardali (forthcoming)). A detailed inventory of L1 Turkic-speaking communities and proportions of languages spoken there, along with local pronunciation of place names, is found on the ALI page for C&B (Taheri-Ardali et al. 2015).

In the following section (“Collecting linguistic data”), we give an account of ongoing activities related to Turkic of C&B, and in particular, current results from the

ALI linguistic data questionnaire that was carried out in 8 Turkic-speaking communities in that province.

Kordestan. Kordestan Province is dominated by Central Kurdish, but there are significant minorities of Southern Kurdish, Horami (Hawrami), and Turkic. At just over 60,000 speakers, L1 Turkic speakers make up about 4% of the province's population (Mohammadirad et. al 2016). They are spread across 138, mostly small, communities in the north-west and south-west corners of the province (Figure 4).

Figure 4: Turkic-speaking communities of Kordestan Province (from: http://iranatlas.net/module/language-distribution.single_language)



In contrast to Turkic-speaking populations of C&B (see above) and Bushehr (see below), most of the towns where Turkic is spoken in Kordestan are ethnically homogeneous. Anonby & Mohammadirad & Sheyholislami (2019: 23) document the existence of three main groups of Turkic speakers in Kordestan: Shāhsavan and “Tāt” (as referred to by its speakers), which are both found in Bijār district in the northwest; and Ghūrva (or Qorveh) Turkic, found as a minority in the city of Qorveh and in about 20 towns and villages to the north and west. These areas are a continuation of a larger Turkic-speaking region in Zanzan Province to the north-east and Hamadan Province to the south-east.

The ALI linguistic data questionnaire has not yet been carried out in Kordestan Province, so the linguistic affiliation and characteristics of the three Turkic-speaking groups there are not yet known.²

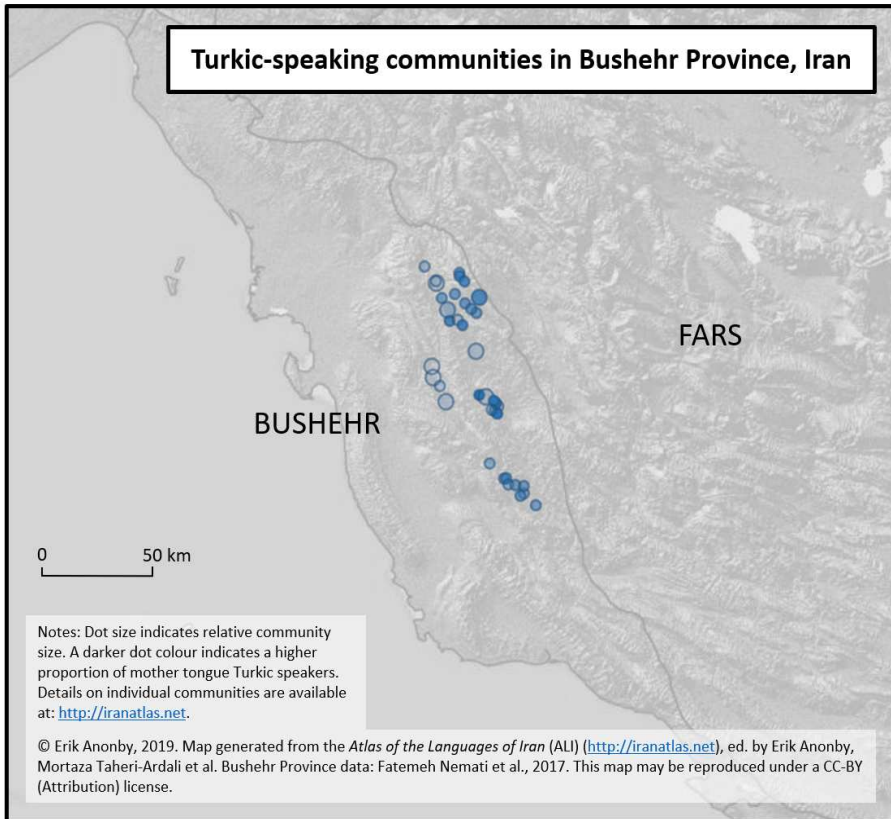
Bushehr. In their work on language distribution in Bushehr Province, Nemati et al. (2017) signal the presence of 38 villages where Qashqai Turkic communities are found (Figure 5). The villages are situated along the north-west edge of the province, and contiguous (across ridges) with the main Qashqai language areas in Fars Province to the east. Almost all of the villages, which are clustered into four groups, are shared with speakers of “Fars Group” varieties—sisters of Persian and Lori (among others) within Southwestern Iranic. In the three northern clusters, Turkic speakers co-exist with the Dashtesuni (Dashtestāni) dialect of the Fars Group, and in the south with the Dashtiyāti dialect. Together, the L1 Turkic-speaking population in these villages is estimated at just over 7500 (Nemati et al. 2017), which is less than 1% of the total population of Bushehr Province, itself at just over one million people (ISC 2011, 2016). See Figure 5 below.

Ilam. So far, it is only in Ilam Province, where our survey of language distribution has recently been completed by Gheitasi et al. (2017), that we have not encountered any Turkic communities.

Upcoming provinces. Language distribution research has been initiated in several other provinces where Turkic is an important language: Zanjan, where Turkic is the dominant language (Rahnema, Mohammadi and Jamaledin, field notes 2016–2019); Hamadan, where Turkic and Iranic languages (Kurdish, Laki, Persian and Lori) appear to cover equivalent portions of the province (Izady and Meshkinfam, field notes 2018–2020); and West Azerbaijan, which, based on our initial observations, hosts a Turkic-speaking minority alongside a larger Kurdish-speaking population (Öpengin et al., field notes 2017–2019). ALI team researchers have also confirmed communities of Turkic speakers during language distribution research in the provinces of Mazandaran (Hashemi Zarabad), Esfahan (Talebi-Dastenaie et al.) and Semnan (Taheri-Ardali and Joolaei). We are on course to complete and publish initial language distribution maps for several of these provinces by mid-2021.

² There is, however, a 40-item wordlist for Ghūrva Turkic available in Haig & Khan & Schreiber (2018: 945–946), which gives some initial indications of how this variety could be classified.

Figure 5: Turkic-speaking communities of Bushehr Province (from: http://iranatlas.net/module/language-distribution.single_language).



Collecting linguistic data for Turkic

In this section, we introduce the ALI linguistic data questionnaire and discuss initial results from its implementation with Turkic languages.

The ALI linguistic data questionnaire

We collect linguistic data for the Atlas by means of a questionnaire, available at <https://carleton.ca/iran/questionnaires>. Interviews, which generally take two to three hours to administer, are accompanied by detailed instructions and comprise 5 content sections:

- Introduction: explanation, permissions, sociolinguistic context;
- Lexicon: a selection of 130 lexical items, accompanied by example sentences and other elicitation supports, and intended for analysis of lexicon, synchronic and historical phonology and lexical semantics;
- Morphosyntax: 138 questions designed and organized based on Haig & Schnell's (2014) GRAID³ system for morphosyntactic tagging and analysis;
- Numbers: this section is based on Chan's (1998) questionnaire on number systems of the world's languages;
- Oral texts: high-quality video and audio recording of a selection of texts, including legends and folktales, songs and poetry, and procedural texts.

The pilot version of the questionnaire was created in 2014, and revised at a workshop in 2017 (<https://www.uni-bamberg.de/en/aspra/workshop-questionnaire-languages-of-iran-2017>). Experts in various language families gave input to ensure that the questions were suited to typological analysis for each language family. For Turkic in particular, Christiane Bulut, Laurentia Schreiber, Geoffrey Haig and Don Stilo critiqued the initial questionnaire and contributed new questions with Turkic languages in mind.

The questionnaire's development, structure, and what it measures are discussed further in Anonby, Taheri-Ardali & Hayes (2019), Taheri-Ardali, Anonby & Haig (in preparation), and Anonby & Taheri-Ardali & Haig et al. (under consideration).

Carrying out the ALI questionnaire with Turkic languages

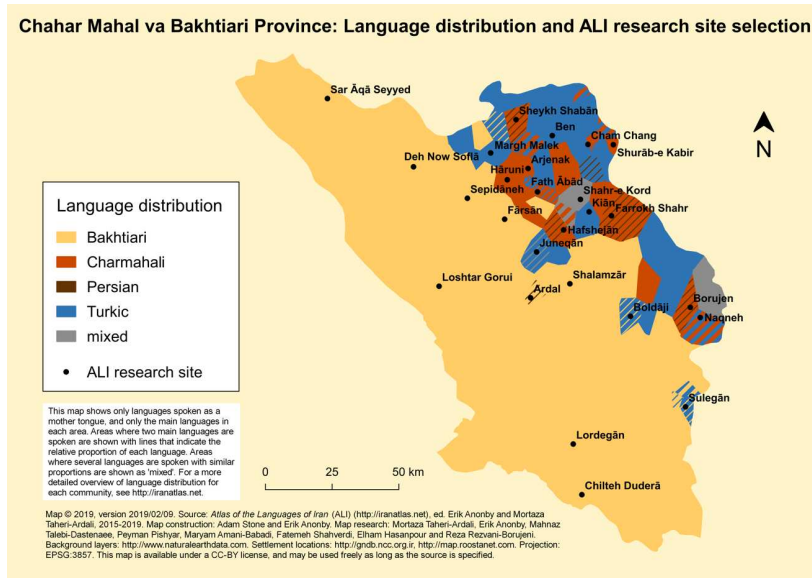
So far, we have carried out the ALI linguistic data questionnaire with 10 Turkic varieties, of which 8 are in Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari (C&B) Province, 1 in Zanjan Province, 1 in Fars Province.

Research on the languages of C&B has been the main focus of questionnaire research until now. From 2016 to 2019, team members (Taheri-Ardali, Pishyar Dehkordi, Talebi-Dastenaee, Shahverdi) carried the questionnaire out with 30 language varieties across the province, including 8 Turkic-speaking communities: Ben, Margh Malek, Shurāb-e Kabir, (Shahr-e) Kiān, Juneqān, Margh Malek, Naqneh, and Sulegān. C&B research sites are shown in Figure 6.

A synopsis of the language situation in C&B, based on initial analysis of the data collected, is presented in a recent article by Anonby, Taheri-Ardali & Stone (under consideration). However, the article does not provide a detailed account of Turkic; most of the article is devoted to lexical and phonological correspondences among Iranian varieties, and Turkic is treated primarily in the context of influence from (and on) Iranian. A fuller treatment of Turkic of C&B, and analysis of the questionnaire's morphosyntax data more generally, are outside of the scope of that study.

³ Grammatical Relations and Animacy in Discourse.

Figure 6: ALI in-depth research locations Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari Province (Anonby, Taheri-Ardali & Hayes 2019, based on: http://iranatlas.net/module/language-distribution.chahar_mahal_va_bakhtiari_static).



Although we have yet to prepare an overview article on Turkic in C&B, we have made some observations that orient our ongoing research there. First, multilingualism is prevalent, but it patterns distinctively within each community. Related to this: as for most languages of Iran, the younger generation is shifting to Persian as a mother tongue. In C&B, this process has become increasingly prominent over the last 10 years, and is more advanced among Turkic communities than among speakers of the regionally dominant language Bakhtiari. In addition, as highlighted in the C&B study mentioned just above (Anonby, Taheri-Ardali & Stone, under consideration), contact influence between Iranian and Turkic is profound. Finally, it is becoming increasingly apparent to us that “Turkic of Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari” is not linguistically unified. The linguistic data we have collected are surprisingly heterogeneous, and the differences go deeper than varied local expressions of Iranian influence: for example, we have encountered several very different phonological systems, both in terms of inventory and allophonic patterning. Variation at the morpho-syntactic level includes the domains of definiteness, e.g., the use of *jogāz* as a definiteness marker; object pronouns, e.g., variation in the form of an oblique pronominal stem *bela-*; progressives, e.g., use of a reduplicated progressive verbal in some varieties; comparatives; and ‘can/be able’ constructions. Some of these, especially Iranian-type progressives and comparatives, can be credited to different degrees of contact influence by neighbouring languages. Even within a single village, there is

often more than one distinct variety spoken, with differences running along family and clan lines. According to regional historians, Turkic-speaking peoples of C&B have diverse historical origins and ethnic affiliations, including at least Seljuk, Shāhsavan and Qashqai Turks (Qāsem Fattāhi 2003).

Before a coherent picture of Turkic in C&B can be compiled, these complex questions need to be investigated from many directions, among others, history, language identity, language contact, and linguistic typology. We have taken steps toward this through four initial studies:

- “Contact-induced morphosyntactic change in Turkic of Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari Province, Iran” (Schreiber & Anonby & Taheri-Ardali & Haig 2017, 2018, in preparation)
- “Notes on phonological patterns in Turkic of Margh Malek, Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari Province, Iran” (Anonby & Taheri-Ardali, in preparation)
- “Phonological convergence in Turkic and Bakhtiari of Juneqan, Iran” (Anonby & Taheri-Ardali, in preparation)
- “Balanced bilingualism: Patterns of contact influence in L1 and L2 Turkic and Bakhtiari speech in Juneqan, Iran” (Anonby & Taheri-Ardali & Schreiber 2020)

Currently, Taheri-Ardali is also preparing a study on the typology of definiteness in the languages of C&B, and this will include Turkic. We are working on making all questionnaire data from C&B available online, and we hope that Turcologists and typologists will be able to carry out analysis on this data from other angles.

In the coming months, Hamadan Province will be our next focus for field research. We plan to carry out the questionnaire in at least 30 locations, about half of which will be Turkic-speaking communities, in 2020–2021.

Conclusion: Progress, challenges and prospects

In this paper, we introduce the *Atlas of the Languages of Iran* (ALI) research programme and provide an overview of the research process and initial results for Turkic languages in Iran. We discuss the importance of language classification for an atlas project, and present a first detailed working classification of all Turkic varieties in the country (Section 2). We then give an overview of initial findings from language distribution research in five provinces: Hormozgan, Chahar Mahal va Bakhtiari (C&B), Kordestan, Bushehr and Ilam (Section 3). Results from implementation of the questionnaire with Turkic languages, and an inventory of ongoing areas of research, are also summarized (Section 4).

This paper brings into focus the extent and diversity of Turkic-speaking communities in Iran, which are often overlooked in the literature and on language maps of the country. We emphasize that while important work has been done by other scholars, the complexity of the language situation merits a systematic approach and par-

ticipation from a broad community of scholars. Our own work, still in its initial stages, makes a modest contribution, and provides initial results for classification, language distribution, and linguistic typology of Turkic languages in Iran.

Current and upcoming areas of concentration on Turkic languages in the ALI programme are: processing of linguistic data collected for Turkic in C&B Province, where the work is most advanced; completion of language distribution maps for the provinces of Hamadan, Zanzan, Esfahan, West Azerbaijan and Semnan; and implementation of the ALI linguistic data questionnaire for Hamadan Province in particular. Together, this work will continue our movement toward the ultimate goal of a deeper understanding, and a more coherent picture, of Turkic languages for all of Iran.

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